



“The sheer speed and scale of digitalisation have created a wealth of data, coming at the right time for AI to make a real difference in healthcare”

PRASHANT TANDON
CO-FOUNDER AND CEO, TATA 1MG

ties, provide customer feedback, and develop scoring systems. Practo offers doctors a digital prescription so the patient gets the prescribed medication without any guesswork over handwriting or dosage.

48 | Shashank says Practo was the first to validate every doctor on its platform and pioneered providing patient feedback. “We introduced the excellence score for hospitals and clinics, reflecting their investment in infrastructure and clinical processes. We conduct physical audits and take photographs of their equipment, simplifying this information for patients,” he explains.

Practo works in three main areas: doctor discovery, telemedicine, and software. “We now have more than five million verified patient feedback reviews, making us the only platform with such a large number of genuine, verified reviews for doctors,” he says.

GROWTH AND MORE GROWTH

India’s digital health sector is growing significantly and is driven by technology and consumer demand. According to Frost & Sullivan, the market, which includes telemedi-

cine, health management apps, and electronic health records, was valued at approximately ₹2.35 lakh crore in 2023. The market is projected to expand to around ₹15.12 lakh crore by 2026, supported by a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of about 26% from 2023.

Ankur Dhandharia, Partner, Healthcare Strategy, EY India, says digital health platforms are powering better diagnostics and opening up personalised care.

“The digital health space continues to see a shift in teleconsult and B2B business models towards B2C and ecosystem play to address wellness to surgery needs of patients. While geographical expansion and partnerships drive growth for players like Medibuddy and Practo, business models are still evolving to address high customer acquisition costs,” says Dhandharia.

Industry experts say that consumer demand is also a significant driver, with increasing interest in convenient and personalised healthcare solutions. Digital platforms offering health tracking, teleconsultations, and customised wellness plans have gained popularity, particularly after the pandemic.

“Practo has experienced signifi-

cant growth by expanding its platform and services in recent years. Practo has diversified into various aspects of healthcare, including telemedicine, diagnostics, and health records management,” says Sanjay Sachdeva, Director of Healthcare & Lifesciences at 1Lattice, a market research and consulting firm.

Three developments are driving healthcare’s growth, says Prashant Tandon, Co-founder and CEO of Tata 1mg, a digital healthcare platform offering online pharmacy services, lab tests, and teleconsultations for accessible healthcare.

“First, the sheer speed and scale of digitalisation have created a wealth of data, coming at the right time for AI to make a real difference in healthcare,” Tandon says.

“Second, all stakeholders—doctors, hospitals, patients—love digital healthcare. Third, government initiatives such as ABDM and the UHI are creating a strong backbone or network,” Tandon says.

The ABDM, or the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission, will enable all Indians to securely store and access their medical records, share them with healthcare providers, consult specialists online, and order medicines without visiting a pharmacy. Doctors will get to see their patient’s records online. The Unified Health Interface is a key part of the ABDM and allows for a seamless user experience, giving each a unique identification number.

So, even as the Practo app could be helping thousands get into online calls with their chosen doctor or book appointments, Shashank’s techies are working quietly on deeper integration with ABDM. Practo has booked an appointment with Dr Profit. **BT**

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